

NICK RIOS

ENGINEERING LEADER

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Senior engineer with 20 years experience and hundreds of millions of page views long before AI. Now that AI does exist it has given me superpowers that massively upgraded my workflow.

- **2001–2005 · Telecom → Software**
Started in telecom operations at AT&T and Sprint, then transitioned to full-stack software development
- **2005–2012 · Media & Web Platforms**
Shipped websites for 60+ TV stations, a national newspaper network, and B2B clients under real deadlines
- **2012–2020 · Cisco — Enterprise Scale**
Scaled Elasticsearch and Neo4j to enterprise volume, and grew from engineer into trusted team leadership
- **2020–2025 · Digital Harbor — AI Leadership**
Built and shipped a 100+ tool AI platform, and led three teams through the company's entire AI adoption
- **AI Integration**
Runs local LLMs, voice, video, images, automation and code. Claude, OpenAI, Gemini, Cursor, LangChain, n8n

EXPERIENCE

Digital Harbor — Team Lead

2020 – 2025

DH was a major brainstorming factory — immense hours spent talking, planning, and prototyping. I sat on an innovation team building next-generation social forms and data capture, centered on a WYSIWYG with built-in components, themes, and templates.

- Team lead of three groups: ran daily scrums, distributed tickets, coded the foundation, and reviewed code
- Developed a shared Angular component library adopted company-wide, significantly improving delivery
- Created and deployed company-wide image and media APIs across Google, Shutterstock, and other providers
- Built an AI agent management platform, used to create and manage over 100 AI agents
- Integrated AI code review agents into GitLab and Teams, triggered automatically on every push
- Started the AI innovation group — ran leadership demos, onboarded new hires, led code discussions

Cisco Systems — Senior Engineer, Team Lead

2012 – 2020

Built a global data-center "single pane of glass" using Angular, Elasticsearch, Neo4j, and Splunk telemetry from UCS servers, with predictive alarms and priorities, while integrating legacy ticketing data and exposing APIs for reporting teams. If DH taught me forms, Cisco taught me data dashboards.

- Solved complex technical challenges such as: merging many data sources into one source of truth
- Rolled out a graph database at a scale that brought neo4j founders to Austin to meet us and talk
- Built predictive alarms and priority scoring on live UCS server telemetry, cutting noise for operators
- Integrated legacy ticketing data and published APIs that reporting teams rolled out to the public
- Won a company-wide innovation award and demoed the product live to globally 4,000+ viewers, including SVPs
- Earned repeat promotions into team leadership by consistently being someone who gets things done

Nexstar Broadcasting — Software Engineer

2005 – 2009

- Migrated more than 60 television station websites onto one shared platform, launched nationwide
- Helped that shared platform scale to reliably serve more than a million visitors in a single day
- Integrated the shared CMS with legacy newsroom, media, and third-party publishing systems

Impremedia — Software Engineer

2009 – 2012

- Built a centralized DAM pipeline for 10+ newspapers and magazine publishing systems
- PHP/Smarty applications backed by MySQL, working directly with the CTO and architect.
- Delivered supporting features, including classified ads, as readership shifted from print to digital.